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TRACK A · AI FOUNDATIONS · KIT 7 OF 20

AI for Workload: Winning Back an Hour a Week

Word-for-Word Facilitator Script: read it aloud exactly as written, or make it your own. Keyed to all 36 slides, with stage directions, a running clock, and answers to the questions staff actually ask.

Facilitator Script · 45–60 minutes

Built by Adam & Katelyn Spinozzi

A husband-and-wife team of certified educators with over 20 combined years in the classroom. Adam is a certified CTE Carpentry teacher; Katelyn is a certified K-8 teacher.

How to use this script

Everything in plain type is meant to be spoken aloud. Read it verbatim (it's written for the ear) or glance and paraphrase once you're comfortable. Either way delivers a complete session. Slide cues, stage directions, and question boxes work exactly as they did in Kits 1 through 6. Run Kits 1 and 2 before this one: today leans on Kit 1's rules and Kit 2's template habit.

Meet Ms. Rivera. Throughout the deck you'll see the same example teacher's screen: Ms. Rivera, our running composite (not a real person; she appears in every kit). When her screen is up, point the room at it; it's the model to mimic in the lab. If someone asks who she is, say exactly that: a fictional teacher we use across the series so you always see what the work looks like before you try it yourself. Her tracker chip sits top-right on every slide; the matching line under each slide cue below tells you what it says, so you always know what the room is reading.

THE STANCE OF THIS WHOLE SESSION

Hand the repetitive to the tool; keep the relational on purpose. If a task requires knowing your kids, it's yours. If it doesn't, it's draftable.

Timing checkpoints

Clock	You should be...	If behind...
0:12	On the recurring-task template (slide 9)	Trim discussion on slides 5–7
0:24	On the protected list (slide 14)	Never trim slides 13–14 or 16; trim slide 15 instead
0:30	Starting the lab (slide 18)	Start it anyway; the lab is the session
0:54	On First 48 Hours (slide 34)	Hold the closing lines; hand out sheets at the door

45-minute version: run two sort calls on slide 12 instead of four, build one template in the lab instead of two (the second moves to the First 48 Hours sheet), take two share-out voices, and read the "45-min cut" stage notes where they appear.

From the founders

→ This note is from Adam and Katelyn Spinozzi, the two certified teachers who wrote this kit. It's here to give you their perspective before you present. Sharing it is entirely your call: read parts aloud where they fit, retell them in your own words, or keep it to yourself as background. The session is complete either way.

We're Adam and Katelyn, and here is why this session matters for what happens in your classrooms: the profession is running its people empty. In Gallup's February 2022 workforce survey, K-12 reported the highest burnout of any industry in the country, and the hours doing it aren't the teaching hours; they're the pile that follows teachers home. Nobody entered this work to feed that pile. When the repetitive parts of the job get cheaper, what's actually being bought back is the energy teachers spend on kids, and the version of this career a person can keep for twenty years instead of five.

The lessons we believe this hour will leave with your staff: how to audit a week honestly and see which tasks never needed a teacher's judgment; how to turn the two worst repeaters into templates that work every time; why the recovered hour has to be spent on purpose, or the pile just refills it; and the line that keeps the whole trade honest, that the relational work, the reason any of us stayed, is protected by decision and not by accident. The tool takes the paperwork. The teaching was never on the table.

Segment 1 · Welcome & the pile (slides 1–4)

SLIDE 1 Title

0:00

→ Slide 1 up as people arrive. Start on time.

Welcome back. Today's session is the one this whole series has been building toward, because it's about the week itself. Not a technique, not a tool trick: your actual week, audited honestly, with the repetitive parts handed off and the parts you became a teacher for protected on purpose. By the end of this hour you'll know exactly which tasks are eating your evenings, you'll have templates built for the two worst ones, and you'll have written down, in ink, the work you're never handing to a machine.

SLIDE 2 The pile, measured

0:02

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her week: 54 hours, and the pile that isn't teaching keeps growing.

The numbers first, and they're not subtle. Teachers work about 54 hours a week, and less than half of that is actually teaching. And here's the one that should make everyone in this building sit up: Gallup measured burnout across every industry in America, and K-12 came in first. Forty-four percent of K-12 workers, and 52 percent of teachers, say they always or very often feel burned out at work, against 30 percent for everyone else. First place, in the wrong race. The pile is not a personal failing. It's the job's design flaw, and today we go after it directly.

SLIDE 3 The recoverable share

0:04

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her recoverable hours: the drafting share of documentation, planning admin, boilerplate.

Now the hopeful number. Teachers who've made AI a weekly habit report saving about 5.9 hours a week, roughly six weeks a year. Where does it come from? Not from teaching. From the drafting share of the pile: documentation, planning admin, reformatting, routine writing. Every kit so far handed you one piece of that. Today we stop going task-by-task and audit the whole week at once, because the savings compound when you can see the whole pile in one place.

SLIDE 4 Agenda + one promise

0:05

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her goal: week audited, two tasks automated, protected list written.

The hour: first, the two-question sort that splits any week into what's delegable and what never was. Then the automation moves: turning your worst repeaters into templates that work every time. Then the part that keeps this honest: the protected list, the work you keep on purpose. Then the lab: your real week, audited; your two worst repeaters, templated; your protected list, written. That's the promise: you leave with the hour already located, not with advice about finding one.

Segment 2 · The sort (slides 5–8)

SLIDE 5 Question 1: does it require knowing my kids?

0:06

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her sort, question 1: does this task require knowing my kids?

The whole audit is two questions. Question one: does this task require knowing my students? Reading the room during a lesson: yes. Noticing that a quiet kid got quieter: yes. Formatting the same weekly newsletter shell, writing the third sub plan of the semester, turning your notes into a rubric: no. Be honest and be specific, because the pile survives on tasks pretending they need your judgment when they only need your time.

SLIDE 6 Question 2: does it repeat?

0:08

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her sort, question 2: does it repeat? Repeating + generic = automate it.

Question two: does it repeat? A one-off task is worth a good prompt. A repeating task is worth a template, because you build it once and it pays you every week. Cross the two questions and you get four quadrants, and only one of them matters today: tasks that repeat and don't require knowing your kids. That quadrant is where the six weeks a year live.

SLIDE 7 What lands in the delegate pile

0:09

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her delegate pile: sub plans, reformatting, boilerplate, first drafts.

What actually lands there, from real classrooms: sub plans. Station directions. Quiz shells and exit tickets. Newsletter frames. Documentation summaries, de-identified. Syllabus updates. Materials lists. Rubric drafts. Letter-of-recommendation outlines, personalized after. None of these need your judgment to draft; all of them need your review to ship. That distinction is the whole game: drafting is delegable, deciding never is.

SLIDE 8 The banner

0:11

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her banner: save time ON teaching, not FROM teaching.

The banner over today: save time on teaching, not from teaching. The hour we recover doesn't come out of the classroom; it comes out of the pile. If a shortcut ever starts taking time away from kids instead of paperwork, it's not a shortcut we teach. Hold that; the protected list later makes it permanent.

Segment 3 · The automation moves (slides 9–12)

SLIDE 9 The recurring-task template

0:12

Here's the flagship move, on Ms. Rivera's screen: the sub plan she never writes from scratch again. Count the parts: role in teal, an experienced teacher who plans for substitutes. Task in navy: a one-page sub plan. Context in amber, and notice it's all placeholders in brackets: grade, topic, the routine that works. Format in green: bell-ringer, main activity with numbered directions, early-finisher task, management notes. She fills three brackets and runs it. Ninety seconds, every time she's out, forever. That's what a template is: a prompt with the thinking done once.

SLIDE 10 The template recipe

0:15

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her recipe: template any repeating task with [PLACEHOLDERS], build once, reuse forever.

The recipe generalizes to any repeater, three steps. One: write the four-part prompt for one real instance of the task, Kit 2 style. Two: replace everything that changes week to week with a bracketed placeholder: [TOPIC], [GRADE], [DATE], [SKILL]. Three: test it on a second real instance; where it wobbles, add context. When it works twice, it's a template. Save it. You've just deleted a recurring task from your future.

SLIDE 11 Batching + the library

0:17

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her batching move: one sitting, five artifacts; plus the staff doc so nobody solves twice.

Two multipliers. Batching: recurring tasks of the same kind, done in one sitting with one template, five exit tickets for the week in one go instead of five late-night sessions. And the library: every working template goes in the staff prompt doc with your name on it. Thirty teachers each templating two tasks is sixty deleted repeaters, and nobody at this school writes the field-trip checklist from scratch again. The library is how one person's Tuesday night becomes everyone's.

SLIDE 12 Practice: sort the tasks

0:19

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her quadrant calls: relational stays, repetitive-generic goes.

→ *Interactive. Read each task, let the room call it, confirm with the answer strip at the bottom of the slide. 45-min cut: tasks 1 and 4 only.*

Quick practice, call each one: delegate the draft, or keep it entirely? One: the weekly parent newsletter. (Draft it: template plus your voice pass.) Two: deciding which reading group a struggling student joins. (Keep it: that's knowing your kids; nothing about it is draftable.) Three: turning your gradebook notes into progress-report comments. (Split it: AI drafts generic comment shells, you personalize every single one; remember, no student information goes in.) Four: the phone call after a rough day. (Keep it, always; Kit 6's human-only list already settled it.)

Segment 4 · Keeping it honest (slides 13–17)

SLIDE 13 The drift risk

0:21

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her guardrail: 'AI drafts it' never drifts into 'AI decides it.'

Now the honest risks, because efficiency has a failure mode. The drift: "AI drafts it" quietly becoming "AI decides it." It starts innocently, an unreviewed sub plan here, an unread comment there, and ends with a machine making calls about your classroom. The antidote is the rule you've carried since Kit 1: everything gets reviewed, and anything touching a real student gets personalized. Efficiency never outranks judgment.

SLIDE 14 The protected list

0:23

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her protected list: feedback conversations, grading judgment, greeting kids at the door.

And the piece that makes this session different from every productivity workshop you've sat through: the protected list. The relational work doesn't stay yours by accident; it stays yours by decision, written down. Ms. Rivera's list: feedback conversations with students. Grading judgment. Greeting kids at the door. The phone calls that matter. Yours will differ, and writing it is the point: the day you're tired and tempted, the list is the line you already drew. In the lab, you'll write it in ink.

SLIDE 15 Spending the hour

0:26

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her hour, spent on purpose: planning she enjoys, and leaving at a human time.

One more honest minute: the recovered hour disappears unless you spend it on purpose. Parkinson's law runs schools; the pile refills any vacuum. So decide now, out loud, what your hour is for. The planning you actually enjoy. The student who needs ten extra minutes. Leaving at a human time on Fridays. All are legitimate; unassigned is the only wrong answer. This isn't about doing more. It's about doing the job you signed up for, sustainably.

SLIDE 16 The never list

0:28

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her never list: no delegating the relational, no skipping review, no new busywork.

The never list, short and permanent. Never delegate the relational: if it requires knowing your kids, it's yours. Never skip the review: unread output is the drift, and the drift is how trust dies. And never let the saved hour become new busywork: recovered time that turns into three more forms defeats the entire point. Leadership, that last one is partly yours to protect.

SLIDE 17 What this protects

0:29

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her why: the sustainable version of this job is the one she can keep.

What all of it protects: careers. The burnout number from slide 2 isn't a mood; it's the profession's leading indicator, and workload is the piece of it a tool can actually touch. Nobody's claiming a chatbot fixes burnout. But six weeks a year, handed back and spent on purpose, is the difference between the version of this job that empties people out and the version a person can keep. That's the stake. Lab time.

Segment 5 · The lab: your week (slides 18–29)

SLIDE 18 Lab setup

0:30

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her lab artifact: her own week audit, one sheet worked through all four steps.

→ *Dark slide. Devices out, pairs formed inside two minutes. Announce the tool.*

Lab time, twenty minutes, four steps: audit your real week, pick your two worst repeaters, build both templates, write your protected list. Ground rules: no student information of any kind; real tasks from your real week, not hypotheticals; and both templates get tested before they count. Ms. Rivera works hers on screen the whole way, one week audit carried from first star to protected list, with her actual prompt, her finished templates, and her list all printed large as we go; if you ever feel lost, copy her structure. Go.

SLIDE 19 Lab step 1: the audit

0:32

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her week audit, step 1: every repeater listed and starred; worst star, the sub plan.

→ *5 minutes. The handout has the quadrant grid. Ms. Rivera's finished audit is on the next slide in full. Circulate; the common miss is forgetting the small weekly tasks that add up.*

Step one, five minutes: list every task you did last week and will do again, small ones included, because the fifteen-minute repeaters are where the hours hide. Then run the two questions on each: needs my kids? repeats? Everything landing in repeats-but-doesn't-need-my-kids gets a star. Count your stars; most people find six to ten, and each is a candidate. Ms. Rivera's audit is on the screen: four stars, and a column that stays hers. Copy her format.

SLIDE 20 Ms. Rivera's week audit, in full

0:34

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her week audit in full: four stars, one column that stays hers, one worst offender.

→ *Leave this up while pairs work. It is her whole starting artifact, and it is copyable as-is.*

Here is her sheet in full, so nobody has to imagine what an audit looks like. Left column, the starred repeaters, with the minutes attached: sub plans, 45 each time she's out. Exit tickets, 30 a week. Newsletter shell, 20. Materials lists, 15. That's 65 minutes a week before she is ever absent, and none of it needs to know a single kid. Right column, the work that does: reading group calls, feedback conversations, grading judgment, the Tuesday phone call, greeting them at the door. Never starred, not once. And the line at the bottom is where her lab starts: the worst star is the sub plan, and it never begins before nine at night.

SLIDE 21 Lab step 2: build template #1

0:37

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her week audit, step 2: the worst star, the sub plan, is now template #1, tested twice.

→ *6 minutes. Push for testing on a REAL instance, not admiring the template.*

Step two, six minutes: take your worst starred task, the one that costs the most evenings, and build its template. Four-part prompt for one real instance, then bracket what changes, then test it on a second instance. Ms. Rivera's card shows her audit narrowing: her worst star was the sub plan. The next two slides are the exact prompt she typed and every follow-up after it. Mimic her. When it works twice, it's real: save it.

SLIDE 22 The prompt she types into the chat

0:38

→ *Her full chat window is the slide, so no tracker chip here. Point at the colors as you name the parts.*

This is step one of the recipe, write it once, and it is the same four parts from Kit 2 aimed at one real absence. Read the weak version first: "write me a sub plan for tomorrow." Now hers. Role in teal: an experienced 6th grade science teacher writing for a substitute who has never met this class. Task in navy: the one-page sub plan for tomorrow. Context in dark amber, and this is the part people skip: three days into food webs, they can name producers and consumers but not decomposers, the routine that works, and the privacy line, because no student names go in. Format in green: one page, bell-ringer, numbered directions a stranger can follow, an early-finisher task, three management notes. No brackets yet. Brackets are the next step.

SLIDE 23 Her follow-ups, and what each one changed

0:40

→ Her chat window again, so no chip. Read the right-hand column out loud.

Iteration isn't failure, it's the work, and here the recipe from slide 10 is running line by line. She wrote it once, and got a sub plan for one Tuesday: good, and useless next month. Then, "rewrite that as a reusable template, bracket the grade, the topic, where we are, and my class routine." One Tuesday's plan became a form with four blanks. Then she tested it twice: 8th grade, simple machines, two days before a quiz. It held, except the bell-ringer assumed a lab table, and that wobble showed up on her screen instead of on a substitute's desk. Last one: add a line for when the technology fails, keep it to a page, hand it back as plain text with the brackets in. Saved. That whole thread ran in about six minutes, which is what you have right now.

SLIDE 24 Lab step 3: build template #2, share both

0:43

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her week audit, step 3: star #2, exit tickets, is template #2; both go to the staff doc.

→ 6 minutes. 45-min cut: skip #2; it moves to the First 48 Hours sheet.

Step three, six minutes: same recipe, second-worst repeater. On Ms. Rivera's card, that's star #2 off the same audit: exit tickets, templated the same way. Then both templates go in the staff doc's new Workload section, name attached, one line on what each is for. Sixty deleted repeaters, remember; your Tuesday night is about to become everyone's. Her two finished templates are on the next two slides, word for word.

SLIDE 25 Template #1, word for word

0:45

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her sub plan template, finished: five blanks, ninety seconds, never written from scratch again.

→ Leave it up while pairs build. Anyone stuck can copy this structure outright and change only the nouns.

This is the thing itself, not a description of it: her sub plan template exactly as she saved it. Read it straight down the color code. Role: an experienced bracket-grade teacher writing for a substitute who has never met this class. Task: a one-page sub plan for bracket-date, covering bracket-topic. Context: where we are in the unit, the routine that works in this room, no student names and nothing identifying, and what to do if the technology fails. Format: one page, bell-ringer, numbered directions a stranger can follow, an early-finisher task, three management notes. Look at the strip at the bottom: five blanks. That's the whole job now. Ninety seconds, every absence, and she has not written a sub plan from scratch since.

SLIDE 26 Template #2, and its output

0:47

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her exit ticket template, finished: four blanks, tested on a real week.

Her second template is shorter, and that's the point: a template is only as long as the thinking it saves. Left card, the saved artifact, four blanks: grade, objective, how long they've had it, and the thing they usually get wrong. Right card, one real run with the blanks filled in and the questions it produced. Read question five: a student draws the arrow from hawk to rabbit, what's wrong? That question exists because she named the common mistake in the context line. That's what that blank is for. Both templates, written once, bracketed, tested twice, and posted to the staff doc with her name on them.

SLIDE 27 Lab step 4: the protected list

0:49

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her week audit, step 4: the unstarred column becomes her protected list, in ink.

→ 3 minutes, quiet writing, alone. This is the step people remember.

Last step, three minutes, alone and in ink: your protected list. Three to five pieces of this job you are keeping, by decision, no matter how good the tools get. Ms. Rivera's card closes the loop: the lines she never starred in step one are exactly what her list protects. Put yours somewhere you'll see it. This list is why the efficiency is safe: you've named what it will never touch.

SLIDE 28 Her protected list, in full

0:51

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her protected list, finished: five lines, in ink, taped inside her planner.

→ Up while they write, for anyone stalling on the wording. Do not rush this slide, even when the clock is tight.

Hers, word for word, and notice the second line under each one, because the reason is what makes it hold on a tired Thursday. Feedback conversations: the two minutes at a desk where a kid finds out somebody actually read it. Grading judgment: a tool can sort the pile, it cannot decide what this student needed to hear. Greeting them at the door: eight seconds each, and it's how she knows who is having a bad day before class starts. The phone call after a hard day. And which reading group a struggling reader joins, because that call takes a year of knowing the kid, not a week of data. Five lines, and every one of them is a line she never starred back in step one. The templates are how the hour comes back. This page is what the hour is for.

SLIDE 29 Share-out

0:52

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her share-out, from the same audit: the sub plan star, and the evenings it frees.

→ 3 voices, one minute each. 45-min cut: two voices.

Three voices, a minute each: the task you templated, and one line from your protected list. Listen to the protected lists especially; they're this faculty saying out loud what teaching is for.

Segment 6 · Making it stick (slides 30–33)

SLIDE 30 What you just built

0:53

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her inventory: audit done, two templates live, protected list written.

The inventory: a week audited honestly. Two repeaters templated, tested, and shared. A protected list in ink. And an hour with a name on it. That last one is the difference between this session and a productivity poster.

SLIDE 31 Honest limits

0:54

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her honest limits: the tool saves time; it doesn't set boundaries. She does.

Honest limits. The tool saves drafting time; it doesn't set boundaries, fix a broken schedule, or say no to the fourth new initiative; humans do those. The average is 5.9 hours for weekly users, and your number will be yours; the audit, not the average, is what's real. And no tool cures burnout; it just returns some hours. What the building does with that truth is a leadership question worth asking out loud.

SLIDE 32 Our three commitments

0:55

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her commitments: two templates in use, review always, the protected list protected.

Three commitments. One: my two templates get used this week, for real. Two: everything AI drafts gets reviewed; the drift stops with me. Three: my protected list is law; the relational work stays mine on purpose. Can I get a nod on those three?

SLIDE 33 Where this goes

0:56

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her month: template check-ins, a shared library sprint, an hours reckoning.

The month ahead, inside existing PLC time: week two, template check-in, what worked, what wobbled, fix it together. Week three, library sprint: the Workload section gets every working template in the building. Week four, the reckoning: an honest round on what the recovered time went to, because the hour only stays won if somebody asks. Then Kit 8 closes the series by making all of this culture instead of a season.

Close (slides 34–36)

SLIDE 34 First 48 hours

0:56

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her 48 hours: run both templates for real; put the hour somewhere human.

First 48 Hours sheet, three actions: run template one on the real task it was built for. Run template two, or build it if you're on the 45-minute version. And spend the first recovered minutes on the thing you named, then notice that you did. That noticing is the habit that keeps the hour yours.

SLIDE 35 Exit ticket

0:57

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her exit ticket: her two tasks, her protected list's first line.

Exit tickets at the door: your two templated tasks, the first line of your protected list, and the task you still want help automating. Those set follow-up #1's agenda.

SLIDE 36 Close

0:57

Last word. Nobody became a teacher to feed the pile. The pile just got cheaper to feed, and the hours it was eating are on their way back. Spend them like they matter, because they always did. Next session, Kit 8, the last of the core eight: turning everything this series built into your school's culture. Thanks for the hour. Go take one back.

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